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ACCESSORY RETENTION SYSTEM FOR WATERCRAFT

Abstract

A retention system for an accessory for use with a watercraft such as a kayak has a bracket configured to be attached to a body of the watercraft and a retainer member attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket. The retainer member is configured to receive a mounting base, to which a sonar transducer can be mounted. The retainer member is attached to the bracket so that, when the bracket is attached to the body and the mounting base is received by the retainer member, then in the retainer member's first orientation, the mounting base is received by the retainer member so that the sonar transducer is adjacent the elongated body proximate the deck. In the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is received so that the sonar transducer is below the hull.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional App. Ser. No. 63/563,097, filed Mar. 8, 2024, entitled “Stake-Out Pole Retention System For Watercraft,” and of U.S. Provisional App. Ser. No. 63/666,056, filed Jun. 28, 2024, entitled “Accessory Retention System For Watercraft.” Both of the foregoing applications are incorporated by reference herein in their entireties for all purposes.

FIELD

[0002] Embodiments relate generally to accessory retention systems for use with watercraft such as fishing kayaks.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Kayaks are small, relatively narrow, elongated watercraft typically powered by paddling of a human operator or, sometimes in the case of fishing-style kayaks, by a small electric trolling motor or by pedal-operated propellers or paddles driven by the operator's feet. Whitewater-type recreational kayaks typically have a single-structure hull that forms the bottom of the craft, with a deck attached to the hull, thereby forming the top of the craft. The single operator sits in the hull, so that the operator's lower body is within the volume defined between the hull and the deck, with the operator's torso extending up through a hole in the deck's center. Typically, the kayak's forward (bow) and rearward (stern) ends come to points so that the kayaks are generally symmetrical about both an axis aligned with the kayak's dimension of elongation and a transverse axis through the center of the craft. In other kayaks, however, including so-called fishing kayaks, the stern may or may not come to a point but, instead, can be blunt as compared to the bow, and the operator sits atop the deck, often on a chair fixed to the deck, which may have a lowered area in front of the chair upon which the operator may stand or kneel. It should be understood, however, that not all fishing kayaks have blunt sterns.

[0004] Operators of fishing kayaks often wish to secure the kayak's position in the water while the operator fishes. Typically, the operator carries with the kayak a long pole (a “stake-out” or “anchor” pole), sometimes about six feet to about ten feet in length, to push down into the bed of the lake or waterway. If the kayak is to be used in deeper waters, longer poles could be used. The kayak may be tethered to the pole, so that the kayak stays within an area around the pole defined by the tether's length. The tether may be secured to the stake-out pole by a ring that loosely surrounds the pole's outer surface and to which the tether is secured so that the ring can move up and down the stake-out pole as the kayak moves up and down (with respect to the stake-out pole, which is pushed into the bed) in response to waves or tide changes.

[0005] Fishing kayaks may include short track rails mounted on one or both sides of the kayak. Each track has a base screwed to the kayak deck, at the deck's edge. A pair of elongated rails extends upward from the base, defining a volume therebetween with a dimension of elongation generally parallel to the elongated kayak body's dimension of elongation. At the top of the rails, short, horizontal flanges extend inward toward each other but stop short of each other to thereby define a slit between them that is narrower than space below (extending between the elongated vertical rails). The heads of one or more T-bolts are received in the volume between the vertical rails, so that the bolts' threaded distal ends extend upward through the slit. Respective threaded nuts threadedly receive the bolts' threaded distal ends and can be tightened down to bring the heads of the T-bolts up into engagement with the flanges' bottom surfaces, so that as the nut is screwed down into engagement with the flanges' top surfaces, the nut and the T-bolt head engage the flanges to thereby hold the T-bolt in place in the track. By loosening the nut, the operator can move the T-

bolt in the track in either direction in the slit. The T-bolts can be used to secure accessories, such as cameras or depth finders, to the kayak and are sometimes referred to as universal track rails.

[0006] In one mechanism to secure a stake-out pole, a triangular bracket having respective holes at two of the triangle's corners receives the threaded ends of two T-bolts whose T-shaped heads are received in the track rail. Hand actuatable nuts are received over the threaded ends, enabling the operator to secure the bracket onto the kayak edge. The third end of the bracket extends outward of the kayak body to one side, and a vertically oriented through hole slidably receives the stake-out pole. The operator inserts the stake-out pole vertically through the outboard hole in the bracket and pushes the pole into the water body bed, and the loose fit between the bracket and the pole allows the kayak to move vertically with waves or tide change while retaining the kayak laterally with respect to the pole. The bracket may have an arcuate slot extending vertically through the bracket and in communication with one of the two inboard holes at the other bracket corners. When the pole is not received by the bracket, the two hand actuatable nuts can be loosened and the bracket pivoted about one of the T-bolts so that the outboard portion of the bracket can be pivoted inboard over the deck edge as the arcuate groove accepts, and allows that end of the triangular bracket to move with respect to, the other T-bolt.

[0007] Fishing kayaks may also have anchor trolleys, comprised of a metal ring attached to opposing ends of a single length of cable or rope. The rope loops around two pulleys, one at the kayak bow and the other at the stern, so that the rope extends in a long loop adjacent the hull, just beneath one side edge of the deck. The ring is part of that loop and is on its outward half. To anchor the kayak, the operator inserts the stake-out pole vertically through the ring and pushes the pole into the water body bed. The loose fit between the ring and the pole allows the kayak to move vertically with waves or tide change while retaining the kayak laterally with respect to the pole. The operator can further control the kayak's position with respect to the pole by reaching down over the side of the kayak, manually gripping the interior half of the rope loop, and pulling the inward rope away from either the bow or the stern, thereby causing the outer rope half to move, with respect to the kayak, in the other direction via the rope loop's movement about the pulleys. Since the rope's position is stationary at the ring with respect to the stake-out pole, this moves the kayak with respect to the pole. To achieve greater mobility relative to the pole, it is known to connect the pole to the ring on the anchor trolley by a tether.

[0008] It is known to use a hydraulic or electric motor to drive a stake-out pole into the water bed. More generally, it is also known to simply connect the anchor pole to the kayak with a tether, thereby allowing the kayak to move with respect to the pole about and within a circle centered at the pole with a radius of the tether's length.

[0009] It is known to use sonar devices on kayaks to locate fish in the volume of water beneath the watercraft. Kayak manufacturers often form the molded kayak hull with a recessed pocket in which is disposed a mounting device to which the sonar transducer may attach. A sealed hole allows electronic wiring to pass from the transducer up into the kayak hull interior and, then up to the kayak deck, where it connects to a display unit. It is also known to mount the sonar transducer entirely inside the hull, to the interior side of the hull bottom so that the transducer directs its signal through the hull. It is known to attach the transducer to a fixed bracket, which is carried in the kayak until the fish finder is needed. At that point, the operator secures the fixed bracket on the side of the kayak hull, so that the bracket extends the transducer down into the water.

[0010] The present invention may recognize and address one or more considerations of prior art constructions and methods, as recited above or otherwise.

BRIEF SUMMARY

[0011] A watercraft according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure has an elongated body with a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a top

of the body. A bracket is attached to the body. A retainer member is attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket. An elongated stake-out pole is received by the retainer member. The bracket is attached to the body and the retainer member is attached to the bracket so that, in the retainer member's first orientation, the stake-out pole's dimension of elongation is generally parallel to the body's dimension of elongation, and in the retainer member's second orientation, the stake-out pole's dimension of elongation is generally perpendicular to the body's dimension of elongation, and in the retainer member's second orientation, the stake-out pole is outward of a side of the body extending between the forward end and the rearward end.

[0012] In one or more other embodiments, a kayak has an elongated body with a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a top of the body. A chair is attached to the deck. A bracket is attached to the deck and extends across and outward of a perimeter of the body defined by the forward end, the rearward end, and opposing sides of the body at one of the sides of the body, wherein each opposing side extends between the forward end and the rearward end. A collar is disposed at least partially outward of the perimeter and attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket. An elongated stake-out pole is received by the collar so that the collar at least partially encloses an outer perimeter of the stake-out pole. The bracket is attached to the body, and the collar is attached to the bracket, so that, in the collar's first orientation, the stake-out pole's dimension of elongation is generally parallel to the body's dimension of elongation, in the collar's second orientation, the stake-out pole's dimension of elongation is generally perpendicular to the body's dimension of elongation, and in the collar's second orientation, the stake-out pole is outward of the one of the sides of the body extending between the forward end and the rearward end. A selectively engageable first lock is between the collar and the stake-out pole. A selectively engageable second lock is between the bracket and the collar. The second lock is configured to resist movement of the collar out of the first orientation and to resist movement of the collar out of the second orientation.

[0013] In one or more still further embodiments, a retention system for a stake-out pole for use with a kayak having an elongated body with a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a top of the body, has a bracket configured to be attached to the body and a retainer member attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket, wherein the retainer member is configured to receive an elongated stake-out pole. The retainer member is attached to the bracket so that, when the bracket is attached to the body and the elongated stake-out pole is received by the retainer member, then in the retainer member's first orientation, the stake-out pole's dimension of elongation is generally parallel to the body's dimension of elongation, and in the retainer member's second orientation, the stake-out pole's dimension of elongation is generally perpendicular to the body's dimension of elongation, and in the retainer member's second orientation, the stake-out pole is outward of a side of the body extending between the forward end and the rearward end.

[0014] In another embodiment, a watercraft has an elongated body with a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a top of the body. A bracket is attached to the body. A retainer member is attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket. A mounting base is received by the retainer member. A sonar transducer is mounted at a distal end of the mounting base. The bracket is attached to the body, and the retainer member is attached to the bracket so that, in the retainer

member's first orientation, the mounting base is received by the retainer member so that the sonar transducer is adjacent the elongated body proximate the deck. In the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is received by the retainer member so that the sonar transducer is below the deck. In the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is outward of a side of the body extending between the forward end and the rearward end.

[0015] In a still further embodiment, a retention system for an accessory for use with a kayak having an elongated body with a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a top of the body, has a bracket configured to be attached to the body and a retainer member attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket. The retainer member is configured to receive a mounting base. A sonar transducer is mounted at a distal end of the mounting base. The retainer member is attached to the bracket so that, when the bracket is attached to the body and the mounting bracket is received by the retainer member, in the retainer member's first orientation, the mounting base is received by the retainer member so that the sonar transducer is adjacent the elongated body proximate the deck. In the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is received by the retainer member so that the sonar transducer is below the deck. In the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is outward of a side of the body extending between the forward end and the rearward end.

[0016] In another embodiment, a kayak has an elongated body comprising a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a top of the body. A chair is attached to the deck. A bracket is attached to the body. A retainer member is attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket. A mounting base is received by the retainer member. A sonar transducer is mounted at a distal end of the mounting base. The bracket is attached to the body, and the retainer member is attached to the bracket, so that in the retainer member's first orientation, the mounting base is received by the retainer member so that the sonar transducer is adjacent the elongated body proximate the deck, so that in the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is received by the retainer member so that the sonar transducer is below the deck, and so that in the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is outward of a side of the body extending between the forward end and the rearward end.

[0017] In a further embodiment, a kayak has an elongated body comprising a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a top of the body. A chair is attached to the deck. A bracket is attached to the body. A retainer member is attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket. An elongated pole received by the retainer member. The bracket is attached to the body, and the retainer member is attached to the bracket, so that, in the retainer member's first orientation, the pole is received by the retainer member so that the pole's dimension of elongation is generally parallel to the body's dimension of elongation and, in the retainer member's second orientation, the pole's dimension of elongation is generally perpendicular to the body's dimension of elongation.

[0018] In accordance with another embodiment, the present invention provides a retention system for use with a watercraft. The watercraft comprises an elongated body comprising a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a top of the body. The retention system

comprises a bracket configured to be attached to the body and a retainer member attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket. The retention system also comprises a mounting base received by the retainer member, the mounting base having a proximate end and an opposite distal end. When the bracket is attached to the body and the retainer member is attached to the bracket, in the retainer member's first orientation, the mounting base is received by the retainer member so that the mounting base distal end is adjacent the elongated body proximate the deck, in the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is received by the retainer member so that the mounting base distal end is below the deck, and in the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is outward of a side of the body extending between the forward end and the rearward end.

[0019] In a further embodiment, the present invention provides a retention system for use with a watercraft. The watercraft has an elongated body with a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a top of the body. The retention system comprises a bracket configured to be attached to the body and a retainer member attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket. The retainer member is configured to receive an elongated pole. The retention system also comprises at least one watercraft accessory coupled with a distal end of the elongated pole. The retainer member is attached to the bracket so that, when the bracket is attached to the body and the elongated pole is received by the retainer member, in the retainer member's first orientation, the elongated pole is received by the retainer member so that the elongated pole is adjacent the elongated body proximate the deck, in the retainer member's second orientation, the elongated pole is received by the retainer member so that the elongated pole's dimension of elongation is generally perpendicular to the body's dimension of elongation, and in the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is outward of a side of the body extending between the forward end and the rearward end.

[0020] Yet another embodiment provides retention system for use with a watercraft. The watercraft comprises an elongated body comprising a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a top of the body. The retention system comprises a bracket configured to be attached to the body and a retainer member attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket. The retainer member is configured to receive an elongated pole. When the bracket is attached to the body, the retainer member is attached to the bracket, and the elongated pole is received in the retainer member, in the retainer member's first orientation, the pole is received by the retainer member so that the pole's dimension of elongation is generally parallel to the body's dimension of elongation, and in the retainer member's second orientation, the pole's dimension of elongation is generally perpendicular to the body's dimension of elongation.

[0021] The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated in and constitute a part of this specification, illustrate one or more embodiments of the invention and, together with the description, serve to explain the principles of the invention.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0022] A full and enabling disclosure of the present invention, including the best mode thereof,

directed to one of ordinary skill in the art, is set forth in the specification, which makes reference to the appended drawings, in which:

[0023] FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a kayak in accordance with an embodiment of the present invention, disposed on a water body;

[0024] FIG. 2 is a rear perspective view of the kayak as in FIG. 1;

[0025] FIG. 3 is a perspective view of an embodiment of a watercraft accessory retainer, retaining a stake-out pole, on the kayak as in FIG. 1;

[0026] FIG. 4 is a perspective view of the accessory retainer as in FIG. 3 on the kayak as in FIG. 1;

[0027] FIG. 5 is a disassembled plan view of a retainer member and bracket end plate of the accessory retainer as in FIGS. 3 and 4;

[0028] FIG. 6 is a perspective view of the accessory retainer as in FIG. 3, retaining a stake-out pole, on the kayak as in FIG. 1;

[0029] FIG. 7 is a partial side view of the accessory retainer as in FIG. 3;

[0030] FIG. 8 is a partial side view of the accessory retainer as in FIG. 3, retaining a stake-out pole;

[0031] FIG. 9 is a perspective view of a retainer member and bracket end plate of an embodiment of an accessory retainer for use with a kayak as in FIG. 1;

[0032] FIG. 10 is a disassembled plan view of the retainer member and bracket end plate of FIG. 9;

[0033] FIG. 11 is a perspective view of an embodiment of a watercraft accessory retainer according to an embodiment of the present invention, retaining a sonar transducer, for use on the kayak as in FIG. 12;

[0034] FIG. 12 is a perspective view of a kayak in accordance with an embodiment of the present invention, disposed on a water body; and

[0035] FIG. 13 is a rear perspective view of the kayak as in FIG. 12.

[0036] Repeat use of reference characters in the present specification and drawings is intended to represent same or analogous features or elements of the invention according to the disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0037] Reference will now be made in detail to presently preferred embodiments of the invention, one or more examples of which are illustrated in the accompanying drawings. Each example is provided by way of explanation, not limitation, of the invention. In fact, it will be apparent to those skilled in the art that modifications and variations may be made in the present invention without departing from the scope and spirit thereof. For instance, features illustrated or described as part of one embodiment may be used on another embodiment to yield a still further embodiment. Thus, it is intended that the present disclosure covers such modifications and variations as come within the scope of the appended claims and their equivalents. All values indicated below are intended to be approximated values.

[0038] It should be understood that terms of orientation, e.g., “forward,” “rearward,” “upper,” “lower,” and similar terms as used herein are intended to refer to relative orientation of components of the devices described herein with respect to each other under an assumption of a consistent point of reference but do not require any specific orientation of the overall system. Thus, for example, the discussion herein may refer to the “forward,” “rearward,” “lateral,” “side,” or similar descriptions, referring to areas of or directions with respect to a watercraft. Such terms may be used in the present disclosure and claims and will be understood to refer to a relative orientation but not to an orientation of a claimed device with respect to an external frame of reference.

[0039] Further, the term “or” as used in this application and the appended claims is intended to mean an inclusive “or” rather than an exclusive “or.” That is, unless specified otherwise, or clear from the context, the phrase “X employs A or B” is intended to mean any of the natural inclusive permutations. That is, the phrase “X employs A or B” is satisfied by any of the following instances: X employs A; X employs B; or X employs both A and B. In addition, the articles “a” and “an” as used in this application and the appended claims should generally be construed to mean “one or more” unless specified otherwise or clear from the context to be directed to a singular form.

Throughout the specification and claims, the following terms take at least the meanings explicitly associated herein, unless the context dictates otherwise. The meanings identified below do not necessarily limit the terms, but merely provide illustrative examples for the terms. The meaning of “a,” “an,” and “the” may include plural references, and the meaning of “in” may include “in” and “on.” The phrase “in one embodiment,” as used herein does not necessarily refer to the same embodiment, although it may. The phrase “at least one of A and B” is satisfied by any of A alone, B alone, A and B alone, and A and B with others. The phrase “one of A and B” is satisfied by A, whether or not also in the presence of B, and by B, whether or not also in the presence of A. [0040] Various aspects or features will be presented in terms of systems that may include a number of devices, components, modules, and the like. It is to be understood and appreciated that the various systems may include additional devices, components, modules, etc. and/or may not include all of the devices, components, modules etc. discussed in connection with the figures. A combination of these approaches may also be used.

[0041] Referring to FIGS. 1 and 2, a kayak **10** has a body formed by a hull **12** and a deck **14**, each of which may be formed from various materials, such as fiberglass, thermoplastic polymers such as acrylonitrile butadiene styrene (ABS), or aromatic polyamide fiber. While the hull and deck may be formed as a continuous-material structure, as illustrated in the Figures, it should also be understood that the kayak can be formed of discrete panels (e.g., a hull panel and a deck panel) attached by fasteners or adhesive or other constructions. Hull **12** forms the bottom of the body and defines the interface between the body and the body of water when the kayak is in use but may also be considered to include the structure that extends upward from the waterline to the body edges that turn generally horizontally inward to form the kayak's top surface, or deck, **14**.

[0042] The body of kayak **10** has a bow **16** that is defined as a ridge formed by the intersection of two opposing sides **18** and **20** of the hull and deck. Those opposing sides extend rearward from the bow to a blunted stern **22**. A chair **24** is attached to deck **14** at a middle portion thereof. Chair **24** may be attached to the deck in a fixed orientation, with the sitting position thereof facing toward bow **16** or with capability to swivel side to side from the forward-facing orientation. The deck defines vertically recessed portions **26** and **28**, respectively aft and fore of chair **24**. Recessed portion **26** may receive accessory gear, such as an ice chest **33**, while recessed portion **28** provides a surface upon which to rest the user's feet when the user sits in chair **24** or on which to stand or kneel. Thus, as should be understood in this art, the deck may not be a level surface and may have portions thereof that are lower than the deck's highest surface.

[0043] As illustrated in FIG. 2, kayak **10** includes a pair of stake-out poles **30**, each disposed on a respective side **18/20** of the kayak body by respective pairs of retainers **32** and **34** and respective tethers **36**. Each stake-out pole has an elongated rigid shaft **38** and a handle **40** at one end of the shaft, with the pole being approximately six feet long in its dimension of elongation, although other lengths may be used. The shaft of each pole may be made of any suitable material, such as fiberglass, aluminum, or polyvinyl chloride (PVC).

[0044] At the kayak body's forward end, each aluminum front retainer **32** is secured to the kayak by one or two T-bolts extending upward from a universal track rail **42** secured to forward edge **18** or **20** of body deck **14**. The (or each) T-bolt shaft extends upward through a respective slot (in one or more embodiments, in which there are two slots, the slots are elongated and parallel to each other, similar to the slots **54** in bracket **56**, FIG. 3, discussed below) in an elongated bracket portion **44** of retainer **32**. A threaded nut is threaded down onto the upward-facing threaded distal end of the T-bolt shaft and is tightened onto the bolt thread to engage the top of bracket portion **44** and thereby secure retainer **32** to the kayak body. A downward-facing yoke portion **46** of retainer **32** is formed by two downward-depending flanges that define therebetween a downward-opening slot that receives stake-out pole shaft **38**.

[0045] As apparent in FIG. 2, the slot of yoke portion **46** of retainer **32** is sufficiently wide to provide a sliding fit for pole shaft **38** but to also engage the shaft. Tether **36** has a looped upper end

that is attached to the kayak deck edge by a cleat or to small handle strap fixed to the deck by one or more screws or pop rivets and, at its lower end, to a carabiner or other manually operable clip, which is itself attached to the kayak body, e.g. by screws or pop rivets, or by attachment to such a handle strip that is itself attached to the kayak body by such means. As should be understood, such tethers are sometimes provided on the kayak by the manufacturer to store related gear. To secure the tether about the pole shaft, the operator grips the tether's loose lower end, wraps the tether around the pole shaft, and secures a loop at the tether's lower end into the carabiner or, if the carabiner is fixed to the tether and selectively attached to the watercraft body by a handle strap that is fixed to the body, secures the carabiner to the handle strap. The tether's length is short enough to bias the pole shaft inward toward the kayak body, more tightly against the inward flange of yoke portion **46** and the inner surface of bore **66** (discussed below) in retainer member **34**, to thereby inhibit the pole's vibrations in its horizontal position as shown in FIG. **2** as the operator moves the kayak over a water surface. The tethers' engagement of the stake-out poles also, by biasing them more tightly into engagement with retainers **32** and **34**, secures the poles in their axial positions with respect to the kayak body. In one or more other embodiments omitting tethers **36**, in which retainer **32** is made of a polymer material, the downward-facing flanges are flexible and have inwardly (toward each other) facing protrusions on the flange ends, and the slot between the flanges is of a width slightly smaller than the pole shaft's diameter, the slot flanges receive the pole shaft in a releasable snap fit.

[0046] Referring to FIGS. **2**, **3**, **4**, and **5**, each of the two retainers **34** on a kayak body side **18** or **20** is secured to the kayak by a pair of T-bolts **50** extending upward from a universal track rail **52** secured to a respective body side edge **18** or **20** generally midway on the body, adjacent chair **24** and the operator's sitting position therein. The T-bolt shafts extend upward through respective slots **54** in an elongated aluminum bracket **56** of retainer **34**. A respective threaded nut **58** is threaded down onto the upward-facing distal end of each T-bolt shaft and is tightened down onto the bolt thread to engage the top of bracket **56** and thereby secure retainer **34** to the kayak body. Bracket **56** includes an aluminum end plate **60** that is attached to the elongated bracket portion (herein "arm") by a pair of Torx-headed screws **62** (FIG. **5**), that depends downward from the arm, and that adjacently faces an aluminum retainer member **64** that defines a through-bore **66** in which stake-out pole shaft **38** is slidably received.

[0047] Aluminum end plate **60** defines a forward face **68** that faces a rearward face **70** of retainer member **64**. A generally cylindrical boss **72** extends from forward face **68** and is received in a through bore **74** of retainer member **64** so that retainer member **64** is rotatable about the axis of boss **72**. In one or more embodiments, through bore **74** is countersunk into face **68**, and the outer diameter of boss **72** is about 0.005" less than the diameter of the initial countersunk portion (**88**) of through bore **74**, thereby allowing relative rotation between those components. When retainer member **64** and end plate **60** are so assembled together that boss **72** is received in bore **74** (for example, as in FIGS. **3** and **4**), a generally cylindrical pin **76** extending forward from face **68** extends into an arcuate groove **78** extending into rearward face **70**.

[0048] Face **70** of retainer member **64** appears larger than face **68** of end plate **60** in FIG. **5** because retainer member **64** has greater depth than does end plate **60**, but it should be understood that the outer perimeter dimensions of faces **68** and **70** are generally equal. With end plate **60** and retainer member **64** abutting each other but otherwise aligned as they are shown in FIGS. **3** and **4** (also shown in FIG. **5**, except that retainer member **64** is rotated 180° about the righthand (in the perspective of FIG. **5**) edge of end plate **60**), pin **76** is received at the lefthand end (in the perspective of FIG. **5**) end of arcuate groove **78** so that the end wall **80** of groove **78** blocks the retainer member's further rotation about boss **72**, in the rotational direction of arrow **86**. Pin **76** and groove edge **80** thereby define a stop between retainer member **64** and bracket **56** that blocks the retainer member's rotation with respect to the bracket in rotational direction **86**, beyond the retainer member's orientation with respect to the bracket as shown in FIGS. **3** and **4** (in the direction away

from the retainer member's orientation with respect to the bracket when pin **76** abuts the opposing edge **84** of groove **78**, which is illustrated in FIG. **6**).

[0049] With end plate **60** and retainer member **64** abutting each other but otherwise aligned as they are shown in FIG. **6**, pin **76** is received at the righthand end (in the perspective of FIG. **5**) of arcuate groove **78** so that end wall **84** of groove **78** blocks the retainer member's further rotation about boss **72**, in the rotational direction of arrow **82**. Pin **76** and groove edge **84** thereby define a stop between retainer member **64** and bracket **56** that blocks the retainer member's rotation with respect to the bracket beyond the retainer member's orientation with respect to the bracket shown in FIG. **6** (in the direction away from the retainer member's orientation with respect to the bracket when pin **76** abuts the opposing edge **80** of groove **78**, which is illustrated in FIGS. **3** and **4**). Arcuate groove **78** is configured so that, considering a plane that includes the center axis of through bore **74** and the center axis of pin **76** when it abuts end **80** of groove **78** and a plane that includes the center axis of through bore **74** and the center axis of pin **76** when it abuts end **84** of groove **78**, those planes intersect, in one or more embodiments, at an angle of generally 90°, and so that an arc half way between the inner and outer surfaces of groove **78** is generally at a constant radius centered at the central axis of through bore **74**. The radial width of groove **78**, extending between the groove's inner and outer surfaces, is slightly larger than the diameter of pin **76** in the same direction, thereby facilitating ease of relative movement between the pin and the groove.

[0050] Through bore **74** is countersunk, with a larger diameter non-threaded portion **88** extending into rearward face **70** of retainer member **64** and a smaller diameter secondary portion **90** defined by the countersunk ledge in the middle of the through bore. Through bore **74** is also countersunk extending inward from the retainer member's forward face **92**, so that the countersunk shelf that defines bore portion **90** is relatively narrow. Boss **72** is received by larger diameter portion **88** of bore **74** so that the boss's central through bore **94** is coaxially aligned with smaller diameter portion **90** of bore **74**. As noted, the outer diameter of boss **72** is smaller than the diameter of larger diameter bore portion **88** by about 0.005", but it is larger than the diameter of the central, smaller bore, portion **90**. The axial length of boss **72** is shorter than the depth of larger diameter portion **88**, so that the distal end of boss **72** does not engage the countersunk flange in bore **74** that forms smaller diameter portion **90**. A generally cylindrical bushing (not shown) is disposed against the distal end of boss **72** so that a non-threaded through bore of the bushing (which has the same diameter as the boss's threaded bore **94**) is coaxial with the boss's threaded bore **94**. The bushing's outer diameter is smaller than the diameter of central bore portion **90**, so that the central flange that defines bore portion **90** permits retainer member **64** to rotate easily about the bushing. The bushing's axial length is greater than the difference between the axial length of boss **72** and the axial depth of bore portion **88** by about 0.010", so that, when retainer member **64** is mounted onto end plate **60** about boss **72**, the bushing extends through central portion **90** into the larger diameter portion through bore **74** that opens into forward surface **92**. A 3/8-inch diameter hex head bolt (not shown) is inserted into the central bore of the bushing from the forward side **92** of retainer member **64** and the larger-diameter portion of bore **74** that opens into forward side **92**, so that the bolt's 16 thread/inch threaded distal end engages the corresponding female thread of bore **94** of boss **72**. In an assembled state, the bolt is threaded into bore **94**, and the bolt's hex head remains forward of bore **90** but within the larger diameter bore portion that opens into the retainer member's forward face **92**. The hex head extends radially outward of the perimeter of central bore portion **90**, so that, when the bolt is tightened into bore **94**, the bolt head retains the retainer member from moving away from bracket end plate **60** along the axis of through bore **94**. The approximately 0.010" difference between the axial length of boss **72** and the axial depth of bore portion **88** permits an approximately 0.010" play between the position of retainer member **64** along the axis of bore **94** at which face **68** engages face **70** and the position of retainer member **64** at which the flange that defines central bore portion **90** engages the bolt head, thereby avoiding a frictional lock between faces **68** and **70** when the bolt is tightened onto the bushing and into the boss, facilitating ease of

relative rotation between retainer member **64** and end plate **60**.

[0051] The head of the hex bolt is received by a hexagonal opening in a base end **96** of a crank arm **98**, that extends into the countersunk portion of through bore **74** that opens into forward face **92** so that manual actuation of crank arm **98** to rotate the crank arm around the axis of base end **96**, which is coaxial with the axis of the bolt, rotates the bolt. Crank base end **96** has an end portion that engages the shoulder that defines central bore portion **90**, a portion of face **92** that surrounds bore **74**, or both. Depending on the direction of that rotation, the crank arm either tightens the bolt further into, or backs the bolt out of, through bore **94**. Upon the operator's actuation of crank arm **98** to tighten the bolt into bore **94**, the crank arm base biases rearward face **70** of retainer member **64** into forward face **68** of bracket end plate **60**, thereby increasing the friction between the two components to a level sufficient to resist the torque on the retainer member caused, when the retainer member is in the position as shown in FIGS. **3** and **4**, by the weight of stake-out pole **30** so that the retainer member remains in its orientation with respect to bracket **56** and to resist the torque on the retainer member caused, when the retainer member is in the position as shown in FIG. **6** and the operator has pushed the stake-out pole into the bed of the water body, by wind or waves acting upon the kayak so that the retainer member remains in its orientation with respect to bracket **56** as shown in FIG. **6**. Upon the operator's actuation of crank arm **98** to back the bolt in the outward direction in bore **94**, the crank base loosens that bias, or even slightly disengages from the retainer member, thereby releasing the frictional lock between faces **68** and **70** and allowing the axial play created by the bushing length to allow the retainer member to rotate freely about boss **72** and the axis of bore **94**.

[0052] As indicated above, retainer member **64** forms a collar about shaft **38** of stake-out pole **30**, retaining the stake-out pole shaft in position with respect to the retainer member. In one or more embodiments, the collar is formed by the complete encirclement of a perimeter of the stake-out pole shaft by the material of retainer member **64**, forming through bore **66**, as shown in FIG. **4**, though it should be understood in view of the present disclosure that other configurations of the collar are possible, for example comprising a snap release bracket in an enclosure by the retainer member that is less than 360°. Thus, it should be understood that the example of the retainer member, and other structures, illustrated in the embodiments discussed herein are for purposes of example only.

[0053] The construction of the opposing faces **68** and **70** of bracket end plate **60** and retainer member **64** of the starboard side retainer **64** are the same as those of the port side retainer **34**, as shown in FIG. **5**, except that groove **78** is the mirror image of the groove **78** of the port side retainer about a vertical (in the perspective of FIG. **5**) plane bisecting face **68** of bracket end plate **60**. If the starboard side faces **68** and **70** are viewed in the orientation as shown in FIG. **5**, edge **80** of groove **78** remains directly below through bore **74**, but groove **78** extends to the left (in the view of FIG. **5**) rather than to the right, and groove edge **84** is to the left of through bore **74**. This change, then, reverses rotational directions **82** and **86**, so that the operator deploys retainer member **64** from the transport position to the anchoring position by rotating retainer member **64** toward the bow. In one or more other embodiments, the retainer member and bracket end plates on the port and starboard sides have the same configurations. In such embodiments, the orientation of starboard-side retainer **32** is reversed, so that the slot defined by its end flanges opens upward. The starboard-side stake-out pole is reversed, so that the pole's handle is at the pole's forward end. Retainer member **64** rotates toward the kayak's stern in moving retainer **64** to the anchoring position, rotating the pole's forward end upward, out of retainer **32**.

[0054] Referring to FIGS. **3**, **4**, and **6-8**, the diameter of collar through bore **66** is greater than the outer diameter of shaft **38** of stake-out pole **30**. As discussed above, the force applied to the stake-out pole by tether **36** inhibits the stake-out pole's movement axially with respect to the through bore's axis. Thus, in one or more embodiments, no further retention mechanism is included in the system to inhibit the pole's axial movement with respect to retainers **32** and **34**. In one or more

other embodiments, however, a selective lock is implemented, in addition to or instead of tether **36**, to retain the pole axially with respect to the through bore's axis by a manually operable polymer (or other material) screw **100** that is threaded through a correspondingly threaded through bore through a top surface **102** of retainer member **64**, so that a distal end of the polymer screw engages the outer diameter of pole shaft **38** and pushes the opposite side of the pole shaft against the far side of through bore **66**, frictionally retaining the pole shaft with the screw's distal end and with the opposing side of through bore **66**. It should be understood that this arrangement is presented for purposes of example only and that other arrangements, such as clamps, grommets or other suitable structures held by a retainer member and engaging the pole shaft, may be used to resist the pole's axial movement with respect to the retainer member. Thus, the illustrated example is not a limitation of the present disclosure.

[0055] Referring to FIGS. **1**, **2**, **3**, **5**, and **6**, the operator controls the orientation of retainer member **64** with respect to bracket **56** to move the two stake-out poles **30** between transport positions and anchoring positions. For each pole, when its retainer member **64** is in the position with respect to bracket **56** at which pin **76** abuts end **80** of groove **78** in face **68** of bracket end plate **60**, retainer member **64** is oriented, as shown in FIGS. **3** and **4**, so that the stake-out pole is in a transport position in which the axis of through bore **66** is aligned generally horizontally (assuming the disposition of kayak **10** on a body of water), so that the stake-out pole's dimension of elongation is generally parallel to the kayak's dimension of elongation. The pole is disposed outboard of and generally parallel to the hull's side, just beneath the deck's edge (or at least beneath a highest point of the deck), where the deck meets the hull. Because the bracket extends outward of a perimeter of the kayak body defined by the bow, the stern, and opposing body sides **18** and **20** so that the retainer member is outward of the perimeter, yet is also close to the hull and not above the level of the deck edge, the pole's position minimizes the likelihood that the pole will interfere with the operator's reach when paddling the kayak or operating accessory equipment. The pole's forward end is received by the slot in retainer **32** and is biased into the inward flange thereof by tether **36**, thereby minimizing the likelihood that the pole will undesirably flex into the hull at the kayak's forward end. With the stake-out poles in this position, with the retainer members **64** tightened down into the position as shown in FIGS. **3** and **4** by crank handles **98**, and with the poles secured in retainer **34** by screws **100** and/or tether **36**, the operator launches the kayak into the body of water and drives the kayak, e.g. through paddling or a trolling motor, to a desired location, e.g. at which the operator wishes to fish.

[0056] If, on the water, the operator desires to anchor the kayak, the operator disengages tether **36** from the carabiner (or releases the carabiner from its attachment to the kayak body), thereby releasing one of the stake-out poles from that restriction. The operator reaches down to the pole's retainer **34** and grips and turns handle **98** to thereby loosen the corresponding retainer member **64** from its frictional engagement with the bracket end plate **60**. Assuming the retainer **34** is on the kayak's port side, the operator then grips retainer member **64** and rotates it with respect to bracket end plate **60** about boss **72** in direction **82**, toward the kayak bow. As retainer member **64** starts rotating, the stake-out pole's engagement in the retainer member causes the stake-out pole to rotate in the same direction, causing the shaft **38**'s distal end to move downward, out of engagement with its retainer **32**. If the operator continues to rotate the retainer member, pin **76** eventually engages end **84** of groove **78**, at which point retainer member **64**, and stake-out pole **30**, have rotated approximately 90°, to the position shown at FIG. **6**, so that the stake-out pole's dimension of elongation is generally perpendicular to the kayak's dimension of elongation. The operator manually turns screw **100**, if present, in the direction to back the screw out of its threaded hole through the retainer member, thereby releasing the screw's engagement with the pole shaft. The operator then grips stake-out pole handle **40** and pushes the pole downward and into the water body bed, thereby anchoring the kayak. The operator may repeat this operation with the stake-out pole on the kayak's starboard side.

[0057] Because neither tether **36** nor screw **100** now engages the pole shaft in either of the port and starboard retainers, and each retainer member can therefore move with respect to its pole shaft, the kayak can freely move up and down with waves or tide changes.

[0058] The process reverses when the operator wishes to move the kayak. The operator pulls up on handle **40** of the port side stake-out pole until it clears the water body bed and the pole reaches the position at which the operator wishes to secure the pole in retainer member **64**. The operator actuates screw **100**, if present, in the direction into the threaded hole in the top of the retainer member until the screw's distal end engages the pole shaft to thereby frictionally retain the pole shaft (in its axial direction) between the screw's distal end and the opposing side of through bore **66**. The operator then grips retainer member **64** and rotates it, in direction **86**, from the position shown in FIG. **6** back to the position shown in FIGS. **2** and **3**, at which point pin **76** again engages end **80** of groove **78** and the end of pole shaft **38** reengages with the yoke slot of retainer **32**. The operator wraps tether **36** back around pole shaft **38** and retains the tether with the carabiner. The operator repeats the process with the starboard-side stake-out pole (if it had been deployed) and thereafter moves the kayak to the next desired location.

[0059] FIGS. **9** and **10** illustrate a still further embodiment of retainer member **64** and bracket plate **60** in which a spring-loaded plunger, or pop pin, **104** replaces both the hand-actuatable crank **96/98** (FIGS. **3**, **6**, **7**, and **8**) and the pin **76** (FIG. **5**) of the above-described embodiments. In embodiments as in FIGS. **9** and **10**, aluminum end plate **60** defines a forward face **68** that faces a rearward face **70** of retainer member **64**. A generally cylindrical boss **72** extends from forward face **68** and is received in a double countersunk through bore **74** of retainer member **64**. The diameter of boss **72** is slightly less (in one or more embodiments, for example, approximately 0.005" less) than the diameter of the large diameter portion **88** of the countersunk bore of bore **74** extending into retainer member face **70**, thereby permitting retainer member **64** to rotate about the axis of boss **72**. A cylindrical bushing (not shown) having an outer diameter slightly less than the diameter of a smaller-diameter central portion **90** of through bore **74** defined by a relatively narrow shoulder between the two larger-diameter countersunk portions of bore **74** has an axial length that is approximately 0.010" longer than the difference in axial length between boss **72** and initial countersunk bore portion **88** of bore **74**, so that the bushing extends through smaller-diameter central portion **90** as it extends from the distal end of boss **72**. The bushing has a non-threaded through bore having approximately the same diameter as the diameter of threaded bore **94** centered in boss **74**, and the two bores are coaxially aligned with each other. A threaded bolt (not shown) extends into bore **74** from the countersunk portion **118** of bore **74** that opens into forward surface **92** of the retainer member so that the bolt's threaded distal end is threadedly received in threaded bore **94** of boss **72**. The bolt's head remains on the opposite side of the inwardly depending shoulder in bore **74** that defines smaller-diameter portion **90**, within the countersunk portion of bore **74** that opens into forward face **92**. The bolt head's diameter is greater than the diameter of center bore portion **90**, thereby retaining retainer member **64** against movement away from end plate **60** along the axis of bores **74** and **94**. The bushing is about 0.010" longer than the difference between the lengths of boss **72** and countersunk bore portion **88** (boss **72** is shorter than the depth of bore portion **88**) so that retainer member **64** can move slightly in either direction along the axial dimension of bores **94** and **74** (between a position of retainer member **64** when it engages the opposing surface of the bracket end plate and a position of retainer member **64** when the inwardly depending shoulder that defines central bore portion **90** engages the bolt head), even when the bolt is fully threaded into bore **94** of boss **72**. This facilitates relative rotation between the retainer member and the bracket end plate, in that the bolt's engagement into threaded bore **94** does not frictionally lock retainer member face **70** against bracket end plate face **68**. When retainer member **64** and end plate **60** are assembled together (bracket end plate **60** is attached to the bracket arm, which is attached to a universal track rail in the same manner as discussed above, by a pair of screws that extend into the countersunk bores at the top of the bracket end plate as shown in FIG.

10) so that boss **72** is received in bore **74** and the retainer member and bracket end plate are dimensionally aligned with each other (for example, similar to the arrangement as in FIGS. **3**, **4**, and **9**), a generally cylindrical pin (not shown) of spring-loaded plunger **104** extends through bracket member rearward face **70**, from a through hole **106**, and extends from rearward face **70** into an arcuate groove **78** defined in forward face **68** of the bracket end plate.

[0060] Spring-loaded plungers are well understood, and their specific construction and operation is, therefore, not discussed in detail herein as it applies generally with regard to the variety of forms and operations in which they may be provided. In one or more examples as illustrated in FIGS. **9** and **10**, however, spring-loaded plunger **104** has a handle end **110** with a hollow shaft portion **112** that receives an elongated pin (not shown) in a fixed relationship. This plunger pin passes through a central through bore of an annular collar **114** that is separate from handle **110** and shaft portion **112** and that has a threaded lower end (not shown) that threads into a corresponding female thread at the end of bore **106** as that bore opens into forward face **92** of retainer member **64**, thereby fixing the spring-loaded plunger in the retainer member. At a lower portion of the plunger pin, but short of the pin's distal end, there is a radially extending annular shoulder (not shown) having an outer diameter that is slightly smaller than the inner diameter of bore **106** so that the pin, including the annular collar, moves freely in bore **106** in the bore's two axial directions but generally does not move from side to side. A coil spring (not shown) abuts, at one end of the spring, the top of the pin's annular shoulder and, at the opposite end of the spring, the bottom of threaded annular collar **114** (e.g., either at the bottom of the threaded portion itself or at a countersunk inner shoulder within the threaded portion). The spring is in compression, so that it thereby biases the pin toward bracket end plate **60** and into annular groove **78** and, therefore, biases handle **110/112** into engagement with the top of annular collar **114**, in the position shown in FIG. **9**. If the operator, however, grips handle **110** and pulls the handle away from threaded annular collar **114** against the spring bias, the handle moves away from collar **114**, pulling the pin through collar **114** and partially out of bore **106** through face **92** of retainer member **64**, further compressing the spring. If the operator releases handle **110**, the spring moves the pin and handle back into the position shown in FIG. **9**. In view of the present disclosure, it will be apparent that variations in the structure and operation of the spring-loaded plunger may be employed and that the present discussion is for purposes of example only.

[0061] Face **70** of retainer member **64** appears larger than face **68** of end plate **60** in FIG. **10** because retainer member **64** has greater depth than does end plate **60**, but it should be understood that the outer perimeter dimensions of faces **68** and **70** are generally the same. FIGS. **9** and **10** illustrate a retainer member and bracket end plate from a starboard-side retainer **64**. With end plate **60** and retainer member **64** abutting each other but otherwise aligned as they are shown in FIG. **9**, and similar to the arrangement in FIGS. **3** and **4** (also similar to the arrangement shown in FIG. **5**, except that retainer member **64** of FIG. **10** is rotated 180° about an axis parallel to the lefthand (in the perspective of FIG. **10**) edge of end plate **60**), the plunger pin is received at the righthand end (in the perspective of FIG. **10**) end of arcuate groove **78** in a blind bore **108** in groove **78** so that the pin's engagement within bore **108** blocks the retainer member's further rotation about boss **72**, in the directions both of arrow **82** and arrow **86**. The plunger pin and bore **108**/groove edge **80** thereby define a stop between retainer member **64** and bracket **56** (see FIG. **3**) that blocks the retainer member's further rotation with respect to the bracket in direction **86**, beyond the retainer member's orientation with respect to the bracket as shown in FIG. **9** in the direction away from the retainer member's position when the pin is at the other end of groove **78**, while bore **108** also blocks the retainer member's rotation in the opposite rotational direction (**82**).

[0062] In one or more embodiments, spring-loaded plunger **104** is chosen of a size so that, even when the operator pulls handle **110** to its maximum retracted position, so that the plunger spring is at its position of maximum compression, the plunger pin's distal end retracts from bore **108** but does not retract fully into bore **106**. Thus, in handle **110**'s retracted position, the pin's distal end is

retracted clear of bore **108** but remains inserted into arcuate groove **78**. Accordingly, when the handle/plunger pin is in this maximum retracted position, the pin's distal end can move in either direction within arcuate groove **78** but not beyond the groove's end walls **80** and **84**. If the operator releases the handle when the pin is over bore **108**, or over a bore **116** at the opposite end of arcuate groove **78**, such that the spring biases the pin's distal end into either bore, the pin, and therefore retainer member **64** via the pin shaft's location within bore **106**, is rotationally fixed with respect to bracket end plate **60**. If, on the other hand, the operator releases the handle when the pin is over arcuate groove **78** between bores **108** and **116**, the plunger pin's tip engages but moves within the trough of groove **78**, and the retainer member can be rotated in either direction **82** or **86** until the pin reaches either bore **108** or bore **116**, at which point the spring biases the pin's distal end into the bore, thereby locking the retainer member rotationally with respect to end plate **60**. To remove the lock (with respect to the arc of arcuate groove **78** but not beyond, due to end walls **80** and **84**), the operator pulls back on handle **110** until the pin's distal end clears the bore **108** or **116** in which it happens to be received, thereby allowing the operator to rotate retainer member **64** in the one of rotational direction **82** or **86** that moves the pin's distal end in groove **78** toward the other bore **108** or **116**.

[0063] With end plate **60** and retainer member **64** abutting each other but otherwise aligned so that the axes of through bore **66** (which is the same as, and is shown in, FIG. **4** of the embodiments discussed above, although on the starboard side rather than the port side) and the stake-out pole shaft are aligned vertically (as the retainer member and end plate are aligned as shown in FIG. **6**, although again on the starboard side rather than the port side, with retainer member **64** having been rotated toward the bow), the plunger pin distal end is received at the lefthand end (in the perspective of FIG. **10**) of arcuate groove **78** in a blind bore **116** in groove **78** so that the pin's engagement within bore **116** blocks the retainer member's further rotation about boss **72**, in the directions both of arrow **82** and arrow **86**. The plunger pin and bore **116**/groove edge **84** thereby define a stop between retainer member **64** and bracket **56** (see FIG. **3**) that blocks the retainer member's further rotation with respect to the bracket in direction **82**, beyond the retainer member's orientation with respect to the bracket similar to that as shown in FIG. **6** in the direction away from the retainer member's orientation with respect to the bracket when the plunger pin abuts the opposing edge **80** of groove **78** (which is illustrated in FIG. **9**), while bore **116** also blocks the retainer member's rotation in the opposite rotational direction (**86**). Arcuate groove **78** is configured so that, considering a plane that includes the center axis of through bore **74** and the center axis of bore **108** of groove **78** and a plane that includes the center axis of through bore **74** and the center axis of bore **116** of groove **78**, those planes intersect, in one or more embodiments, at an angle of generally 90°, and so that an arc half way between the inner and outer surfaces of groove **78** is generally at a constant radius centered at the central axis of through bore **74**. The radial width of groove **78**, extending between the groove's inner and outer surfaces, is slightly larger than the diameter of the plunger pin in the same direction, thereby facilitating ease of relative movement between the pin and the groove.

[0064] The construction of the opposing faces **68** and **70** of bracket end plate **60** and retainer member **64** of the port side retainer **64** are the same as those of the starboard side retainer **34**, as shown in FIG. **10**, except that groove **78** is the mirror image of the groove **78** of the starboard side retainer about a vertical (in the perspective of FIG. **10**) center plane bisecting face **68** of the bracket end plate and except that the position of through bore **106** through the retainer member is mirror image of the through bore's position of the starboard side retainer about a vertical (in the perspective of FIG. **10**) center plane bisecting face **70** of the retainer member. If the port side faces **68** and **70** are viewed in the orientation as shown in FIG. **10**, bore **106** in face **70** is below and to the right of through bore **74**, rather than below and to the left, as in FIG. **10**. Groove **78** remains directly below through bore **74**, but the positions of edges **80** and **84**, and of bores **108** and **116**, are reversed. These changes, then, reverse rotational directions **82** and **86**, so that the operator deploys

retainer member **64** from the transport position to the anchoring position by rotating retainer member **64** toward the bow. In one or more other embodiments, the retainer member and bracket end plates on the port and starboard sides have the same configurations. In such embodiments, the port stake-out pole extends from retainer **34** to a retainer **32** mounted on the kayak's stern, and retainer member **64** rotates toward the kayak's stern in moving the retainer to the anchoring position.

[0065] As discussed with respect to one or more embodiments above, the diameter of the collar through bore in the retainer member that receives the stake-out pole is greater than the outer diameter of shaft **38** of stake-out pole **30** (FIGS. **1** and **2**, and similar to FIG. **8**). Although not present in the embodiment of FIGS. **9** and **10**, in one or more similar embodiments, to retain the pole axially with respect to the through bore's axis, a manually operable polymer screw, such as a screw **100** as in FIG. **8**, is threaded through a correspondingly threaded through bore through a top surface **102** of retainer member **64**, so that a distal end of the polymer screw engages the outer diameter of the pole shaft, thereby establishing a frictional lock between the screw and the pole shaft and between the pole shaft and the opposing inner surface of the through bore.

[0066] Referring additionally to FIGS. **1**, **2**, **3**, **5**, and **6**, the operator's control of the orientation of the embodiments of retainer member **64** as illustrated in FIGS. **9** and **10** with respect to bracket **56** to move the two stake-out poles **30** between transport positions and anchoring positions is similar to that discussed above with respect to FIGS. **1-8**. For the starboard side pole, when its retainer member **64** is in the position with respect to bracket **56** at which the plunger pin is received in blind bore **108** and abuts end **80** of groove **78** in face **68** of bracket end plate **60**, retainer member **64** is oriented, similar to the orientation as shown in FIGS. **3** and **4**, so that the axis of through bore **66** is aligned horizontally and the stake-out pole is in the transport position, as discussed above. With both stake-out poles in this position (and secured by the retainers **32** and tethers **36**), with each plunger pin received in its blind bore **108** to thereby lock the retainer members with respect to the brackets, the operator may launch the kayak into the body of water and drive the kayak, e.g. through paddling or a trolling motor, to a desired location.

[0067] To anchor the kayak, and assuming actuation of the starboard side pole, the operator disengages starboard tether **36**, as described above, and reaches down to the starboard retainer **34** and pulls handle **110** of spring-loaded plunger **104** outward, away from forward face **92** of retainer member **64** to thereby retract the plunger pin's distal end from blind bore **108**, but retaining the pin's distal end within arcuate groove **78**, thereby allowing the pin to move within the groove and the retainer member to rotate with respect to the bracket end plate to the extent permitted by the plunger pin's engagement with groove **78**. The operator then rotates retainer member **64** with respect to bracket end plate **60** about lug **72** in direction **82**. As retainer member **64** starts rotating, and the plunger pin's distal end clears the opening of bore **108**, the operator may release plunger handle **110**. The spring of spring-loaded plunger **104** then pushes the pin down into engagement with the bottom of arcuate groove **78** between bores **108** and **116**, but the pin's tip slides along the groove with the retainer member's rotation. As the retainer member thus rotates, the stake-out pole's engagement in the retainer member causes the stake-out pole to rotate in the same direction, causing the shaft **38**'s distal end to move downward, out of engagement with its retainer **32**. If the operator continues to rotate the retainer member, the plunger pin eventually engages end **84** of groove **78**, at which point the plunger spring biases the plunger pin's distal end down into blind bore **116**, again rotationally locking the retainer member with respect to the bracket end plate. At this point, retainer member **64**, and stake-out pole **30**, have rotated approximately 90°, to an anchoring position such as that shown at FIG. **6** (although on the kayak's starboard side, rather than the port side). The operator then grips stake-out pole handle **40** and pushes the pole downward and into the water body bed, thereby anchoring the kayak. The operator may repeat this operation with the stake-out pole on the kayak's port side.

[0068] The process reverses when the operator wishes to move the kayak. The operator pulls up on

handle **40** of one of the stake-out poles until it clears the water body bed and the pole reaches the position at which the operator wishes to secure the pole in retainer member **64**. The operator then pulls plunger handle **110** outward, away from forward face **92** of retainer member **64** to thereby retract the plunger pin's distal end from blind bore **116**, while retaining the pin's distal end within arcuate groove **78**, thereby allowing the pin to move within the groove and the retainer member to rotate with respect to the bracket end plate to the extent permitted by the plunger pin's engagement with groove **78**. The operator then rotates retainer member **64** with respect to bracket end plate **60** about lug **72** in direction **86**, from the position such as shown in FIG. **6** back to the position such as shown in FIGS. **2,3**, and **9**, at which point the plunger pin again engages end **80** of groove **78** and is biased by the plunger spring back into blind bore **108**, and the end of pole shaft **38** reengages with the yoke slot of retainer **32**. The operator wraps tether **36** back around pole shaft **38** and retains the tether with the carabiner. The operator repeats the process with the other stake-out pole (if it had been deployed) and thereafter moves the kayak to the next desired location.

[0069] Referring to FIGS. **11-13**, a retainer **34** is used to secure to kayak **10** a watercraft accessory other than a stake-out pole. In this example, the accessory is a fish finder sonar transducer and an associated mounting pole therefor, but it should be understood that other accessories may be used. In the illustrated one or more embodiments, retainer **34** is constructed in either of the two embodiments discussed above, or in another suitable arrangement in view of the present disclosure, except that the cross sectional diameter of through bore **66** through which a transducer mounting pole **120** extends is increased to approximately 1.51" in order to accommodate an approximately 1.5" cross-sectional diameter of the main shaft of pole **120** (over its entire length below its handle), as opposed to the diameter of stake-out pole shaft **38** (FIGS. **2, 6**, and **8**). In other embodiments, the diameter of through bore **66** may be larger, to the extent greater play between the two components is desired. As the construction and operation of retainer **34**, and the manner of its mounting to kayak **10**, in these embodiments are the same as discussed above with respect to the embodiments discussed above with respect to FIGS. **1-10**, that discussion is not repeated but should be understood to be incorporated herein.

[0070] Transducer mounting pole **120** includes a mounting base for a sonar transducer, in this example an elongated main shaft **122** that has a hollow interior, thereby defining an interior volume about an axis **124** in the dimension of the mounting pole's elongation. In one or more embodiments, main shaft **122** is made of fiberglass but, in other embodiments, may be made of aluminum or other suitable material. A lower through hole **126** extends through the wall of mounting pole **120** proximate a lower end **128** of the pole, while an upper through hole **129** extends through the mounting pole's wall proximate an upper pole end **130**. Due to the pole's hollow construction, the two through holes are in operative communication with each other.

[0071] In one or more embodiments, a bracket **132** connected to a sonar transducer **134** is releasably attached to mounting pole **120** proximate pole end **128**. One or more communication and/or power electrical wires or cables **138** extend from transducer **134**, through the hollow volume of main shaft **122**, and out of hole **129**. Electrical cables **138** extend to and electrically connect to a processing unit (not shown) that houses the fish finding system's data collection and processing capability. The processing unit is not accessed by the kayak operator during use and so is disposed in an out-of-the-way location in the watercraft, e.g., under the operator's chair. A further cable **138** extends from the processing unit to a display monitor **160**, as illustrated in FIGS. **12** and **13**, that receives signals via the cables that correspond to the data acquired by sonar transducer **134** and that drive display monitor **160** to display images of objects below the deck, and in one or more embodiments below the hull, of kayak **10**, such as fish, the waterway bottom surface, and debris and other waterway bottom features. For ease of illustration, the processing unit is not illustrated in the Figures, and cables **138** are illustrated as running directly from the transducer to display unit **160**, but it should be understood that the present disclosure encompasses the inclusion of the intermediate processing unit.

[0072] Main shaft **122** passes through an annular collar **146** that surrounds the main shaft. A set screw **148** passes through the wall of annular collar **146** and is threadedly engaged with the hole through the annular collar wall. Thus, set screw **148** may be turned in either rotational direction to extend further into, or retract away from, the collar's central opening. By tightening the screw down onto the outer surface of tube main shaft **122**, so that the set screw's threaded end engages the main shaft, when the collar is located at a desired position on the main shaft, the operator secures the collar at the desired position. Because the outer surface dimensions of collar **146** are greater than those of the circumference of through bore **66** through retainer member **64**, collar **146** provides a stop to define the main shaft's maximum sliding position with respect to retainer **34** (and, thereby, with respect to the kayak hull), in one direction along the axis of through bore **66**. Collar **146** thereby acts as a fast location device by which the operator can insert distal end **128** of the main shaft into and through through-bore **66** and slide the main shaft to the desired position, e.g., a position such that when the transducer mounting pole is disposed by retainer **34** in the deployed position, distal end **128** is sufficiently below the waterline and below, or otherwise oriented with respect to, the kayak hull that the kayak hull does not interfere with the sonar signal of sonar transducer **134** such as indicated in FIG. **13**. Collar **146** thus acts as a height gauge for the main shaft that thereby easily locates the sonar transducer at a desired depth underwater with respect to the kayak deck and/or hull. By loosening set screw **148**, and thereby releasing the collar on the main shaft, the operator can alter the collar's position on the main shaft as desired, tightening the screw at the new position, or may remove the collar altogether.

[0073] Opposing through holes **140** and **142** through the wall of main shaft **122** receive an approximately 0.75" fiberglass (or other suitable material, such as aluminum) handle shaft **144** so that handle shaft **144** extends entirely through main shaft **122** proximate its upper end **130**. Holes **140** and **142** are slightly larger in cross section than the outer diameter of handle shaft **144** so that handle shaft **144** is slidably received therethrough. A handle grip **158** at one end of handle shaft **144** has a diameter greater than that of through holes **140** and **142**, thereby precluding the handle from falling through the holes and into the water body when the transducer mounting pole is in the transport position, as shown in FIG. **12**.

[0074] A steel end cap **150** of handle shaft **144** opposite collar **146** with respect to the tube's main shaft **122** is pointed, both facilitating the handle shaft's insertion through the main shaft holes **140** and **142** and, depending on the orientation of transducer **134** on the tube at the tube's lower end, providing a visual indication of that orientation to the kayak operator. Generally, the transducer is attached to the tube main shaft so that, when the transducer is mounted on the main shaft, the transducer's sonar beam is directed downward. As should be understood, however, sonar transducer brackets (see **132**) are known that permit the transducer to have variable orientation with respect to the collar, such that once the transducer is mounted onto pole main shaft **122**, e.g. when retainer **34** holds main shaft **122** in the position as shown in FIG. **13**, the operator can adjust the orientation of the transducer with respect to the main shaft so that, when retainer **34** holds main shaft **122** in the deployed position as shown in FIG. **12**, the transducer's sonar beam is directed in a desired direction, e.g., generally horizontally in order to detect fish in covered locations. Tube holes **126** and **140** are in the same rotational position on the tube main shaft. If the operator, when mounting the transducer on the tube main shaft's lower end, secures the transducer by bracket **132** so that the transducer is rotationally aligned on the main shaft on the opposite side of the main shaft from hole **126**, and if the operator inserts the handle shaft initially through hole **140** so that pointed end **150** is on the side of the tube main shaft of hole **142**, pointed end **150** indicates the transducer's location with respect to the tube main shaft. If the operator also knows the transducer's orientation with respect to main shaft **122**, pointed end cap **150** also provides information about the direction of the transducer's sonar beam. Further, by loosening set screw **100** (FIGS. **7** and **8**) in retainer **34** while retainer **34** is in the deployed position as shown in FIG. **12** and main shaft **122** is vertically secured because collar **146** is secured to main shaft **122** and rests on retainer **34**, the operator can rotate the

tube main shaft (through manipulation of handle shaft **144**) within retainer through bore **66** (FIGS. **7** and **8**) about the main shaft's axis of elongation until handle shaft pointed end **150** points in a direction at which the operator desires to locate the sonar transducer, thereby locating the sonar transducer (and, depending on the transducer's orientation with respect to main shaft **122**) in that desired position.

[0075] A clear anodized aluminum end cap **152** is disposed at upper end pole end **130**. A set screw **154** passes through the wall of end cap **152** and is threadably engaged with the hole through the end cap. Thus, set screw **152** may be turned in either rotational direction to extend further into, or retract away from, the volume beneath the cap and, because end **130** of tube main shaft **122** at end **130** along axis **124** is open, within the interior of tube main shaft **122**. Set screw **154** is of a length sufficient to reach the outer surface of handle shaft **144** when the set screw is disposed in the threaded hole through cap **152**. Thus, by tightening the screw down onto the outer surface of handle shaft **144**, so that the set screw's threaded end engages the handle shaft, the operator secures the handle shaft in position with respect to tube main shaft **122**.

[0076] As apparent in view of the discussion immediately above in view of the embodiments described in conjunction with FIGS. **1-10**, retainer **34** secures and maintains tube main shaft **122** in position with respect to the kayak hull, selectively in a transport position in which the elongated main shaft is disposed horizontally adjacent to the hull and proximate the deck edge and in a deployed position in which the main shaft is disposed vertically adjacent to the hull and the deck edge so that the sonar transducer is below the hull's waterline a distance at least sufficient so that the kayak hull does not interfere with the transducer's sonar beam (this distance may be adjusted by the operator, e.g. through manipulation of collar **146**, to accommodate selected positioning of the transducer with respect to main shaft **122**, as discussed above). Thus, in one or more embodiments, the pole is movable by the operator between the transport and deployed positions by an approximately 90° rotational movement of retainer **34**. Generally, the operator maintains transducer mounting pole in the transport position that is parallel (in terms of its dimension of elongation) with the dimension of elongation of the kayak deck and so that tube main shaft and the sonar transducer are both above the water line, adjacent the hull when paddling or trolling between a water put in/take out position and a fishing area on the water body and in the deployed position when in the fishing area. In one or more arrangements, the operator may secure a first retainer **34** on one side of the kayak to hold the sonar transducer system and a second retainer **34** on the other side of the kayak to hold a stake-out pole, but, in other arrangements, the operator has only one retainer **34** to secure one or the other, or another, accessory. For instance, it is known, while fishing in a kayak in conjunction with fish finding sonar, to paddle or troll the kayak on the water body while monitoring the fish finder (see **160**), such that the sonar transducer and the stake-out pole are not deployed simultaneously.

[0077] With transducer mounting pole in the transport position, as discussed above and shown in FIG. **12**, retainer **34** secures main shaft **122** so that it is aligned horizontally, adjacent the kayak hull. As the main shaft is shorter than the stake-out pole, no tether or secondary retainer (see **32**, in FIG. **2**) is used to additionally secure the transducer mounting pole in position in the illustrated embodiment, but it should be understood that the present disclosure encompasses the use of a tether and/or a secondary retainer to additionally retain the transducer mounting pole in that position. To move the transducer mounting pole to the deployed position, and assuming that the pole is secured to the kayak by a retainer **34** on the kayak's port side (as reflected by the discussion above, a retainer **34** retaining transducer mounting pole **120** could be disposed on the kayak's starboard side) and, for purposes of explanation only, that an embodiment of retainer **34** as in FIGS. **9-10** is used, the operator disengages the tether, if present, that additionally secures the transducer mounting pole to the kayak, reaches down to the port retainer **34**, and pulls handle **110** of spring-loaded plunger **104** outward, away from forward face **92** of retainer member **64**. This retracts the plunger pin's distal end from blind bore **108**, but retains the pin's distal end within arcuate groove **78**, thereby

allowing retainer **34** to operate as discussed above with respect to FIGS. **9** and **10**. In this example of a port-side retainer **34**, and referring again to FIGS. **9** and **10**, the construction of the opposing faces **68** and **70** of bracket end plate **60** and retainer member **64** of the port side retainer **64** are the same as those of the starboard side retainer **34**, as shown in FIG. **10**, except that groove **78** is the mirror image of the groove **78** of the starboard side retainer about a vertical (in the perspective of FIG. **10**) center plane bisecting face **68** of the bracket end plate and except that the position of through bore **106** through the retainer member is mirror image of the through bore's position of the starboard side retainer about a vertical (in the perspective of FIG. **10**) center plane bisecting face **70** of the retainer member. If the port side faces **68** and **70** are viewed in the orientation as shown in FIG. **10**, bore **106** in face **70** is below and to the right of through bore **74**, rather than below and to the left, as in FIG. **10**. Groove **78** remains directly below through bore **74**, but the positions of edges **80** and **84**, and of bores **108** and **116**, are reversed. These changes, then, reverse rotational directions **82** and **86**, so that the operator deploys retainer member **64** from the transport position to the deployed position by rotating retainer member **64** toward the bow. Thus, the operator then so rotates retainer member **64** with respect to bracket end plate **60** about lug **72** in direction **82** (again, reverse from the direction shown in FIG. **10**). As the retainer member thus rotates, the transducer mounting pole's engagement in the retainer member causes the mounting pole to rotate in the same direction, causing the main shaft distal end **128** to move downward and, if a secondary retainer (such as retainer **32**, FIG. **2**) is present, out of the secondary retainer. Referring also to FIG. **10** (although, as noted, in mirror image), if the operator continues to rotate the retainer member, the plunger pin eventually engages end **84** of groove **78**, at which point the plunger spring biases the plunger pin's distal end down into blind bore **116**, again rotationally locking the retainer member with respect to the bracket end plate. At this point, retainer member **64**, and transducer mounting pole **120**, have rotated approximately 90°, to an operative position such as that shown at FIG. **13**. The distal end **128** of main shaft **122**, and sonar transducer **134**, now being below the water line in the deployed position, the operator connects signal and/or power cables **138** into the fish finder **160** for display of information provided by cables **138** from the transducer, actuates the display, and proceeds to operate the sonar system. As discussed above, the operator may adjust the sonar transducer's rotational position about axis **124** by loosening set screw **100** (FIG. **8**) and manipulating handle shaft **144** until its pointing end **150** points in the desired direction for the sonar transducer's location, as discussed above.

[0078] The process reverses when the operator wishes to move the transducer mounting pole from the deployed position back to the transport position. Referring again also to FIGS. **9** and **10** (again, in mirror image), the operator pulls plunger handle **110** outward, away from forward face **92** of retainer member **64** to thereby retract the plunger pin's distal end from blind bore **116**, while retaining the pin's distal end within arcuate groove **78**, thereby allowing the pin to move within the groove and the retainer member to rotate with respect to the bracket end plate to the extent permitted by the plunger pin's engagement with groove **78**. The operator then rotates retainer member **64** with respect to bracket end plate **60** about lug **72** in direction **86**, from the position such as shown in FIG. **13**, back to the position such as shown in FIG. **12**, at which point the plunger pin again engages end **80** of groove **78** and is biased by the plunger spring back into blind bore **108**. If a retainer such as retainer **32** (FIG. **2**) is present, main shaft **122** re-engages with the yoke slot of the secondary retainer. If a tether, such as tether **36** (FIG. **2**) is used, the operator wraps tether **36** back around main shaft **122** and retains the tether with a suitable device, such as a carabiner.

[0079] Many modifications and other embodiments set forth herein will come to mind to one skilled in the art to which these embodiments pertain having the benefit of the teachings presented in the foregoing descriptions and the associated drawings. For example, while the examples discussed herein are described with respect to kayaks, it should be understood that the structures and methods as discussed herein may be used with other watercraft. Therefore, it is to be understood that the embodiments are not to be limited to the specific embodiments disclosed and

that modifications and other embodiments are intended to be included within the scope of the invention. Moreover, although the foregoing descriptions and the associated drawings describe example embodiments in the context of certain example combinations of elements and/or functions, it should be appreciated that different combinations of elements and/or functions may be provided by alternative embodiments without departing from the scope of the invention. In this regard, for example, different combinations of elements and/or functions than those explicitly described above are also contemplated within the scope of the invention. Although specific terms are employed herein, they are used in a generic and descriptive sense only and not for purposes of limitation.

Claims

1. A retention system for use with a watercraft, the watercraft comprising an elongated body, comprising a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward and forming a top of the body, the retention system comprising: a bracket configured to be attached to the body; a retainer member attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket; and a mounting base received by the retainer member, the mounting base having a proximate end and an opposite distal end; wherein, when the bracket is attached to the body and the retainer member is attached to the bracket, in the retainer member's first orientation, the mounting base is received by the retainer member so that the mounting base distal end is adjacent the elongated body proximate the deck, in the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is received by the retainer member so that the mounting base distal end is below the deck, and in the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is outward of a side of the body extending between the forward end and the rearward end.
2. The retention system as in claim 1, further comprising a sonar transducer coupled with the mounting base distal end.
3. The retention system as in claim 1, wherein the watercraft is a kayak.
4. The retention system as in claim 1, wherein the bracket extends outward of a perimeter of the body defined by the forward end, the rearward end, and opposing sides of the body at one of the opposing sides of the body so that the retainer member is outward of the perimeter, wherein each opposing side extends between the forward end and the rearward end.
5. The retention system as in claim 1, wherein the retainer member comprises a collar that at least partially encloses an outer perimeter of the mounting base.
6. The retention system as in claim 5, comprising a selectively engageable lock between the collar and the mounting base.
7. The retention system as in claim 6, wherein the lock comprises a manually actuatable threaded screw that extends through a wall of the collar so that a distal end of the threaded screw is selectively engageable, upon the threaded screw's rotation, with an outer surface of the mounting base.
8. The retention system as in claim 1, wherein the retainer member is attached to the bracket pivotably about an axis.
9. The retention system as in claim 8, comprising a first stop between the retainer member and the bracket that blocks rotation of the retainer member with respect to the bracket beyond the first orientation away from the second orientation and a second stop between the retainer member and the bracket that blocks rotation of the retainer member with respect to the bracket beyond the second orientation away from the first orientation.
10. The retention system as in claim 8, comprising a lock between the bracket and the retainer member, the lock between the bracket and the retainer member being configured to resist

movement of the retainer member out of the first orientation and to resist movement of the retainer member out of the second orientation.

11. The retention system as in claim 1, wherein the mounting base is an elongated, generally cylindrical member.

12. The retention system as in claim 11, comprising a handle attached to an end of the generally cylindrical member opposite the mounting base distal end.

13. The retention system as in claim 1, wherein the bracket is configured to be attached to the deck and to extend across and outward of a perimeter of the body defined by the forward end, the rearward end, and opposing sides of the body at one of the sides of the body, wherein each opposing side extends between the forward end and the rearward end, the bracket comprises a collar disposed at least partially outward of the perimeter; the mounting base comprises an elongated pole received by the collar so that the collar at least partially encloses an outer perimeter of the pole, wherein when the bracket is attached to the body and the collar is attached to the bracket, in the collar's first orientation, the pole's dimension of elongation is generally parallel to the body's dimension of elongation, and in the collar's second orientation, the pole's dimension of elongation is generally perpendicular to the body's dimension of elongation.

14. The retention system as in claim 12, further comprising a selectively engageable first lock between the collar and the pole, and a selectively engageable second lock between the bracket and the collar, the second lock being configured to resist movement of the collar out of the first orientation and to resist movement of the collar out of the second orientation.

15. A retention system for use with a watercraft having an elongated body with a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a top of the body, the retention system comprising: a bracket configured to be attached to the body; a retainer member attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket, wherein the retainer member is configured to receive an elongated pole; and at least one watercraft accessory coupled with a distal end of the elongated pole, wherein the retainer member is attached to the bracket so that, when the bracket is attached to the body and the elongated pole is received by the retainer member, in the retainer member's first orientation, the elongated pole is received by the retainer member so that the elongated pole is adjacent the elongated body proximate the deck, in the retainer member's second orientation, the elongated pole is received by the retainer member so that the elongated pole's dimension of elongation is generally perpendicular to the body's dimension of elongation, and in the retainer member's second orientation, the mounting base is outward of a side of the body extending between the forward end and the rearward end.

16. The retention system of claim 15, wherein when the bracket is attached to the body, in the retainer member's second orientation the watercraft accessory is below the hull.

17. The retention system as in claim 15, wherein the bracket is configured to be attached to the deck and to extend across and outward of a perimeter of the body defined by the forward end, the rearward end, and opposing sides of the body at one of the sides of the body, wherein each opposing side extends between the forward end and the rearward end, the bracket comprises a collar disposed at least partially outward of the perimeter; the elongated pole is received by the collar so that the collar at least partially encloses an outer perimeter of the pole, wherein when the bracket is attached to the body and the collar is attached to the bracket, in the collar's first orientation, the pole's dimension of elongation is generally parallel to the body's dimension of elongation, and in the collar's second orientation, the pole's dimension of elongation is generally perpendicular to the body's dimension of elongation.

18. The retention system as in claim 17, further comprising a selectively engageable first lock between the collar and the pole, and a selectively engageable second lock between the bracket and

the collar, the second lock being configured to resist movement of the collar out of the first orientation and to resist movement of the collar out of the second orientation.

19. A retention system for use with a watercraft, the watercraft comprising an elongated body comprising a forward end, a rearward end opposite the forward end along the body's dimension of elongation, a hull extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a bottom of the body, and a deck extending from the forward end to the rearward end and forming a top of the body, the retention system comprising: a bracket configured to be attached to the body; and a retainer member attached to the bracket movably between a first orientation with respect to the bracket and a second orientation with respect to the bracket, the retainer member configured to receive an elongated pole; wherein when the bracket is attached to the body, the retainer member is attached to the bracket, and the elongated pole is received in the retainer member, in the retainer member's first orientation, the pole is received by the retainer member so that the pole's dimension of elongation is generally parallel to the body's dimension of elongation, and in the retainer member's second orientation, the pole's dimension of elongation is generally perpendicular to the body's dimension of elongation.

20. The retention system of claim 19, further comprising a sonar transducer coupled with a distal end of the elongated pole.
